



The simplest of all techniques is the Rule of Thirds

and two horizontal lines. The four intersections of these lines are the heart of this rule. Putting your subject on any of these points gives it emphasis. You can also put the subject on any of the vertical lines between the two points on either left or right for a similar effect.

But the rule of thirds applies to almost every type of shot. Scenes where you have to depict something which is calm, stable or related to perfection, a symmetric shot gives better results.

Deciding how much of your subject character is shown in a shot is a thought provoking decision as well. Broadly there are three types of shots designated for characters. Long, medium and close-up. Long shot is the only shot where you show the whole body of your character. It is used to present the environment the character is situated in and also highlight full body languages. Medium shot shows the full character only cut from a little above the knees. Bringing the camera closer makes the audience focus a little more on the character than the background. Actions which involve torso, arms and facial expressions, but not legs are best captured with this. Interactions with people also become a little more intimate with this framing. Finally, in the close-up shot, the camera only shows the head of the character and some of the shoulders. This one is solely to show the expressions. Mixing a long and a close-up shot is a good way to introduce the scenario and the character stuck in it. Like showing a kid sitting outside the school principal's office and then cut to a close-up, showing his tensed face. You instantly understand what's happening in this shot, without